

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 116

By Hale

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend George McDonald on his being named the 2024 Tennessee Farmer of the Year.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as agricultural leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such outstanding person is George McDonald, who was named the 2024 Tennessee Farmer of the Year by University of Tennessee Extension in coordination with the Tennessee Farm Bureau Federation and was honored by the University of Tennessee Institute of Agriculture at its annual Ag Day event in Knoxville on September 14, 2024; and

WHEREAS, Mr. McDonald was also honored to represent the State of Tennessee in the thirty-fourth annual Southeastern Farmer of the Year competition at the Sunbelt Ag Expo in Moultrie, Georgia, last October; and

WHEREAS, the Farmer of the Year Awards highlight each farmer's long and distinguished career in such areas as ag production, marketing, business management, applied research, environmental innovations, community service, and contributions to industry-related organizations and their community; and

WHEREAS, the 1996 Tennessee Farmer of the Year, George McDonald, has a long and storied career as a farmer, having known that he wanted to continue the farming legacy of his family at a young age; and

WHEREAS, Mr. McDonald's Catesa Farms grows more than 9,000 acres of corn, soybeans, wheat, milo, hay, watermelons, and strawberries, and in addition, he operates Cumberland Valley Ag, which sells various necessities and stores crops for local producers; and

WHEREAS, since the passing of his father, Mr. McDonald has continued to evolve the farm to keep pace with market needs, such as moving away from dairy to focus on other commodities, and he has a forward-facing vision that always seeks to incorporate cutting-edge agricultural technology for the good of the environment and the consumer; and

WHEREAS, distinctive in his consistent excellence, Mr. McDonald was honored in 1990 as Young Farmer of the Year, and capitalizing on his vast experience, he has served the agricultural industry at the county, state, and national level, being a member of the Smith County Farm Bureau and having held seats on the Smith Farmers Co-Op Board of Directors, Tennessee Corn Promotion Board, North American Strawberry Growers Association, and Tennessee Farm Bureau State Board of Directors; and

WHEREAS, it is Mr. McDonald's pride and joy to be able to farm alongside his daughter, Sarah; his mother, Linda; Kyle Cato; and more than forty full-time and part-time employees and contract workers; and

WHEREAS, Mr. McDonald was nominated for this prestigious honor by Katie Martin, agriculture agent and director of UT Extension Smith County, who praised him as a smart businessman, a passionate agriculturist, and an integral part of his community, and applauded his outstanding advocacy for the farming industry, his commitment to efficiency, sustainability, and diversification, and his allegiance to his employees, whom he treats like family; and

WHEREAS, George McDonald exemplifies the spirit and dedication that are characteristic of a true Tennessean, and we find it appropriate to honor and commend such an outstanding and remarkable individual; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate George McDonald of Smith County upon his

selection as the 2024 Tennessee Farmer of the Year and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success in all his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.